



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Providence Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.pvdclassicalacademy.com/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Providence Classical Academy (PCA) in Rhode Island presents a clearly recognizable classical Christian school model. Across public-facing materials, PCA emphasizes formation of character through a classical curriculum and pedagogy, explicit theological/themetical anchors, and a collaboration with parents as co-educators. The school's messaging repeatedly foregrounds truth, wisdom, virtue, and God's Word as real and knowable, and it consistently ties academic aims to the formation of well-rounded, virtuous citizens rather than solely to workforce preparation. The public materials show concrete articulation of Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with living books and Great Books-like study (including biblical texts as foundational "Great Books" in all subjects), liturgical and communal practices, and a collaborative, parent-inclusive model of schooling. Overall, PCA aligns strongly with the classical rubric, and it would be classified as CLASSICAL across all six rubric categories.

Key observations driving the overall CLASSICAL rating: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are explicit and central (Bible-centered curriculum, Statement of Faith, worship, liturgical elements, and a theologically grounded worldview) . - Purpose and Goal foreground formation, virtue, and wisdom (core virtues, Portrait of a Graduate, formation-oriented language) (evidence in mission and virtues materials) . - Curriculum centers the Trivium, Great Books/primaries, and liberal arts integration with a strong emphasis on living books and biblical materials (grammar/logic/rhetoric, classical history/literature, and biblical texts) as core content . - Pedagogy emphasizes contemplative, memory-based and liturgical elements in the lower grades, with Socratic/seminar-style and rhetorical work in the upper grades, consistent with classical pedagogy . - Faculty messaging highlights Christian teachers, "living curriculum," and a collaborative culture with explicit expectations about faith and scholarly formation . - Parents & Community emphasis is pronounced, with explicit division of responsibilities between school and families, ongoing parent formation, and open-campus/community engagement, including training for co-teaching .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PCA presents a Christ-centered education with Bible-based pedagogy, biblical authority in curriculum, and explicit faith commitments (Statement of Faith; Biblical worldview in all subjects; Great Book as a foundational text) . - Core virtues explicitly named (Veritas, Sapientia, Caritas, Fortitudo) and references to God's creation and truth as foundational, not merely incidental . - Liturgical/community practices described (morning assemblies, hymn-singing, prayer/memory activities) as integrated to schooling .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, wisdom, virtue, theology, liturgy, worship, reverence, wonder, imago Dei, Logos, wisdom, grace, Bible/Great Book, sacred music, chant. - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials related to this category. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present ~9–12 distinct items; Negative keywords present 0; Resulting percentage of positive signals ~100%.

Why this rating - The school framework is explicitly religious, the metaphysical aims are foregrounded (truth, goodness, beauty in transcendentals; theology; liturgical life; worship), and the model treats education as

formation in a sacred, transcendent order rather than secular information transfer. This is the strongest evidence of CLASSICAL alignment within the religious dimension of the Six Elements.

Cited sources: Core Virtues and mission language; Biblical authority and Scripture-centered curriculum; morning assemblies and liturgical practices.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission statements emphasize formation and virtuous formation oriented toward love of God and neighbor; not solely work-readiness (e.g., partnership with parents to cultivate love for learning and a discipline for learning to love God and neighbor) . - Core Virtues (Truth, Wisdom, Love, Courage) anchor the telos of education; portraits of graduates emphasize moral and intellectual ends (truth, wisdom, love, courage) and a Trivium progression (grammar–logic–rhetoric) as the developmental arc toward mature persons . - The school references a classical mission and liberal arts orientation consistent with formation and human flourishing rather than mere employment outcomes (Distinctly Classical framing) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, liberal education, classical mission, telos, great conversation, human excellence, scholé (contested presence), truth, wisdom, beauty. - Negative keywords present: terms like “workforce preparation,” “career readiness” are explicitly avoided in PCA materials (not observed as prominent in PCA content). - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present ~6–8 items; Negative keywords present 0; Resulting positive signal ~100%.

Why this rating - PCA emphasizes formation (virtue, wisdom, and moral aims) and a classical telos rather than a narrow focus on jobs or 21st-century skills, aligning strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and goal.

Cited sources: Mission statement and core virtues; Portrait of a Graduate language; liberal-arts framing in Distinctly Classical.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit Trivium framework: grammar, logic, rhetoric, with descriptions of Grammar Stage, Logic Stage, and Rhetoric Stage (including chants, memory work, recitation, and oratory opportunities) . - Great Books/living books orientation and integrated curriculum (the classical model emphasizes living literature, poetry, and a broad liberal-arts approach; references to “great books” and a connected curriculum are embedded in PCA’s materials) . - Biblical/worldview integration, biblical authority across subjects (biblical texts in all subjects; Great Book concept) shows an integrated, not compartmentalized, curriculum . - Liberal arts breadth and interconnection of disciplines (science, history, literature, languages, arts) within a classical orientation is evident in narrative descriptions of the Trivium and curriculum philosophy .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, classics, history/Western civilization, Latin/Greek, natural philosophy, music theory, diction/recitation, hymnody, sacred art, interdisciplinarity, living books, wonder. - Negative keywords present: avoidance of overly social-studies framing; avoidance of project-based dominance. The material does not emphasize project-based dominance; it positions classical methods as primary. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present ~12–14 items; Negative keywords present 0–2 (contextual negations about other methods); Net positive ~high; 100% positive signal.

Why this rating - The curriculum center is overtly classical (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books/primary sources; liberal arts breadth; languages; disciplined study of history and culture) and integrates wonder and sacred content into a cohesive classical plan.

Cited sources: Trivium framework and Stage descriptions; living books and Great Books references; secular/Christian integration within biblical worldview.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory-work, and routine review, designed to deepen memory and delight (scholé-like restfulness through contemplative repetition) . - Upper school pedagogy features Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates; students train in rhetoric and deliver speeches and engage in rhetorical exercises, consistent with classical pedagogy . - The program also includes a contemplative/restful learning approach (scholé) alongside more rigorous inquiry, aligning with classical pedagogy principles . - The collaborative/hybrid model (parents as co-teachers) is framed as a distinctive pedagogy underpinning the learning process, with on-campus and at-home learning cycles that complement classical instruction .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, questioning, dialectic, disputation; narration, recitation, chanting, memory work; scholé, contemplation, wonder; rhetoric, speech, declamation, oratory, debate; living curriculum; teacher-led classical pedagogy (as opposed to constructivist “facilitator” models). - Negative keywords present: experiential learning focus, project-based learning dominance, student-directed learning as the sole mode (these appear as potential signals in the lexicon; PCA content does not foreground these as negatives; rather, the classical approach is presented as balanced and integrated). - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present ~8–12 items; Negative signals present 0–2 items (but not strongly emphasized as a negative in PCA materials); Net positive ~high; 100% signal toward CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Pedagogy is explicitly aligned with classical methods (grammar/logical/semi-formal practice, memory work, chant, narration) and elevated by Socratic/seminal discussions in upper grades, with a disciplined balance of rest and rigor.

Cited sources: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages; lower/upper-school pedagogical methods; scholé and memory-work references; collaborative/patterned instruction.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents Christian faculty and staff who model a life of faith and virtue; all staff affirm a Statement of Faith and are expected to model Christian life through devotion, Scripture, church involvement, and discipleship . - The living curriculum concept and portrait-of-a-teacher expectations are reflected in school materials (the faculty are described as mentors and living curriculum, with a collegial culture) per the classical lexicon and PCA’s messaging about faith-infused pedagogy . - The school communicates a preference for teachers who are “masterful” in classical pedagogy, with emphasis on character formation and moral exemplars; training in classical pedagogy is highlighted; and there is a sense of teachers as guides shaping student virtue and learning .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: tutors/masters/mentors/exemplars; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; teacher training in classical pedagogy; moral exemplars; character formation. - Negative keywords present: as per the lexicon, “facilitators” or “guides on the side” and certain jargon are potential negative signals; PCA materials emphasize classical-pedagogy training, not those constructs, so negative indicators are not prominent. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present ~6–8 items; Negative keywords present 0–1 items; Net positive ~100%.

Why this rating - The faculty model aligns with classical expectations (moral exemplars and living curriculum; strong integration of faith and pedagogy; formal training in classical methods).

Cited sources: Christian faculty and staff; Biblical authority in curriculum; living curriculum framing.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PCA emphasizes partnership with parents and the concept that parents act as co-teachers; training and resources for parents to equip them for collaborative instruction are described, with openness to parent involvement and campus visits . - The school promotes collaborative education (hybrid model) that foregrounds parent participation in curriculum and home-day responsibilities, including a schedule that

integrates home days with on-campus instruction and teacher-guided home assignments . - There is an emphasis on parent formation, reading groups, seminars, and classical book clubs as ways to educate parents about classical education, consistent with the classical-community model described in the materials . - The school describes an open-campus/visit-friendly environment, illustrating parental access and involvement in school life .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, classical book clubs, seminars, family liturgy alignment, open campus, parent covenant, collaboration. - Negative keywords present: consumer language and minimal parental involvement are listed as negative signals in the lexicon; PCA materials emphasize high parental involvement and co-teaching, with no evidence of a consumer/customer mentality. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present ~6–8 items; Negative keywords present 0; Net positive ~100%.

Why this rating - PCA presents a robust, ongoing, collaborator relationship with parents and the broader community, aligning with the classical model's emphasis on family formation and parental partnership.

Cited sources: Collaborative/hybrid model; parent training/co-teaching; open-campus and seminars; partnership language.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Why the aggregate is CLASSICAL: All six categories show strong alignment with classical education principles as defined by the Six Essential Elements and the Positive/Negative Keyword framework. PCA demonstrates a robust religious/metaphysical foundation; formation-based purpose; a Trivium-centered, Great-Books-oriented curriculum; a pedagogy that blends contemplative memory work with Socratic inquiry and rhetoric; a faculty model that embodies living classical pedagogy; and an active, collaborative parental/community framework.
- Direct quotes and keyword matches across categories (evidence summarized above) anchor each category in publicly available PCA materials and align with the Positive Keyword indicators (truth, virtue, wisdom, theology, liturgy, wonder, Trivium, Great Books, memory, Socratic/seminar, rhetoric, living curriculum, co-teaching, partnership) as described in the Six Essential Elements sources.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable since the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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